



good enough, and I was always afraid I'd get injured.

Team effort

Gurindervir is far more optimistic about his prospects now. Over the past year, he has been training at the Reliance High Performance Institute in Mumbai. "Right now, I'm training much more systematically. I have a dedicated physio and strength & conditioning advisors working with me. That gives me a lot more confidence," he says.

There's more good news. Gurindervir is no longer training alone. In Mumbai, he is training alongside Manikanta, Animesh (PB 10.27), and 200m national record holder Amlan Borgohain (PB 10.25). This marks the first time in Indian track history that the four fastest runners are training together at the same facility.

"It's a huge help," says Gurindervir. "When I was in

THE NATIONAL RECORD SET BY MANIKANTA HOBLIDHAR (CENTRE) PLACES HIM 1427TH AMONG 100M SPRINTERS. AMONG ALL TRACK AND FIELD EVENTS, INDIA'S MEN'S 100M RECORD RANKS AS THE LOWEST

Jalandhar, I didn't have any runners at the same level as me. I was often training with kids from Class 10 or 12. When you have someone like Manikanta, Animesh, and Amlan, there's a sense of competition. You get that feeling *ki sabse accha karna hai* (you have to do better than the others). That's a really good place to be in. When we compete together, it will push each one of us even harder," he says.

With the four runners — all in

their early 20s and capable of running in the 10.2-second range — training together, coaches believe the next breakthrough could happen soon, triggering collective improvement across the board.

"I think you are going to see a major improvement in 2025," says James Hillier, who coaches Gurindervir, Amlan, and Manikanta in Mumbai. "We're waiting for the first guy to break 10.2. Once that happens, another will break it very